

but had to drop that idea because it was apparently messing the usability of the Smart Reply and Smart Smiley features. You can send pretty much any file type over Allo, and also instantly launch a Duo call from within the chat. While Allo sounds right fantastic on paper, what makes or breaks an instant messaging service is user base. With everyone already on WhatsApp, people didn't have incentives in the form of vastly superior features



We are willing to bet good money that these two are yelling "Can you hear me? I can hear you!"

to convince their friends and acquaintances to download an all new app when they can manage on the existing solutions.

Allo's sister app, Duo, also faces the same fate. Duo is an instant video chatting service whose claim to fame is its Knock Knock feature. As in, people are shown a live version of whatever is happening in front of your camera even before they pick up the call. It also promises calls in HD but at a lower data usage rate with lower bandwidth using the WebRTC and QUIC over UDP protocols. If that went over your head, wireless sorcery is also an apt description. While the ability of Duo to work under suboptimal conditions would've generally been very welcomed in a country like ours, the unfortunate fact is that users haven't yet warmed up to video

calling itself. And thus, the latest attempt at communication by Google also fell by the wayside. It's not for the lack of Google trying however – after the original Pixel launch, Google sent out an email stating that manufacturers now need to preinstall Duo instead of Hangouts on all new phones and the release of a web client for Allo a couple of months ago. Only time will tell if enough people are swayed enough to ditch their current platforms but unfortunately, the future doesn't seem so rosy for Google in this regard.

Gboard (and Indic Keyboard)

Gboard, to put it extremely simply, is your phone keyboard with a search bar built in. And bizarrely, for a product made by Google, it was launched on iOS first and then slowly trickled down to Android later. Gboard allows you to search the web from wherever you may currently be; all you have to do is click the big G on the top corner. It also offers better machine learning